

bicycle accident on April 11, 2024. In that accident, Minor sustained injuries including a concussion, facial and body abrasions, soft tissue neck injury, and ligament tear to right knee. Petitioner represents that Minor received surgical treatment and physical therapy. Petitioner represents that Minor has *not* recovered completely, retaining scarring from the injuries for which counsel acquired an estimate for treatment. Counsel negotiated with the insurer a settlement of \$400,000, of which \$230,445.46 is to be paid to Petitioner behalf of Minor to be placed into an annuity. The deductions are as follows: (1) \$63,752.62 for medical expenses; (2) \$5,801.92 costs; and (3) \$100,000 for attorneys' fees (25% of the recovery). Petitioner prepared a proposed order and a proposed annuity.

Ruling

After careful examination of the Petition, declarations, and proposed orders, the Court finds good cause to approve the Petition. Accordingly, the Petition is granted. The Court will execute the Proposed Order Approving Compromise of Minor's Claim lodged on November 5, 2025.

18. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: N26-0057
CASE NAME: PETITION OF:TOTAL LENDER SOLUTIONS, INC.
HEARING IN RE: PETITION AND DECLARATION REGARDING UNRESOLVED CLAIMS AND DEPOSIT OF
UNDISTRIBUTED SURPLUS PROCEEDS OF TRUSTEE'S SALE
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

Petitioner Total Lender Solutions filed a Petition regarding the proceeds of a Trustee's Sale for the property of Lerline Gandy. On January 15, 2026, this Court approved the Petition and ordered the funds deposited for distribution. On March 24, 2026, Frances Gandy, Lerline Gandy's sole heir, filed a Claim to all of Surplus Funds Deposited with Clerk per Order of Jan 9 2026. It appears that Frances Gandy is arguing that the fees (\$6,658.86) and costs (\$435) awarded to counsel for Total Lender Solutions pursuant to the Court's January 14 order were improvidently granted because Total Lending Solutions unnecessarily filed this action. The Court has received no opposition to this filing; nor, however, has the Court received proof of service of the filing. The filing appears to be a motion for reconsideration, but it was filed outside of the proper time for such a motion, and without explanation. Given all of these concerned, the request is **denied**.

Courtroom Clerk's Calendar
Add On

19. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-02439
CASE NAME: CHANEL READER-JONES VS. MARJORIE RINKER
*FURTHER CASE MANAGEMENT CONFERENCE

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

If either party challenges the tentative ruling at Line 20, there will be a Further Case Management Conference. If the tentative ruling stands, the Court sets a post-arbitration status conference for **Monday, December 14, 2026 at 8:30 a.m.** The parties are ordered to file a joint statement with an update on the arbitration at least seven calendar days in advance of the hearing.

Law & Motion
Add On

20. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C25-02439
CASE NAME: CHANEL READER-JONES VS. MARJORIE RINKER
*MOTION/PETITION TO COMPEL ARBITRATION AND DISMISS OR STAY PROCEEDINGS FILED BY:
RINKER, MARJORIE

FILED BY:

TENTATIVE RULING:

Defendants' motion to compel arbitration is **granted**. The motion to dismiss is **denied**. The action is **stayed** pending the outcome of arbitration. The Court sets a post-arbitration status conference for **Monday, December 14, 2026 at 8:30 a.m.** The parties are ordered to file a joint statement with an update on the arbitration at least seven calendar days in advance of the hearing.

Background

This action arises from Plaintiff Chanel Sanaa Reader-Jones's employment with Defendants Macy's Inc., Macy's Retail Holdings LLC, Macy's Systems and Technology, Inc., and Macy's Sun Valley Shopping Center (collectively, "Entity Defendants") at the Sunvalley Mall Macy's store in Concord from October 2022 to March 2024. Plaintiff alleges the following causes of action against the Entity Defendants and individual defendants Marjorie Rinker, Jashay Bingham Cherry, Scott Kennell, and Heather Meredith ("Individual Defendants"): (1) discrimination (FEHA); (2) hostile work environment harassment (FEHA); (3) retaliation (FEHA); (4) failure to provide reasonable accommodation (FEHA); (5) failure to engage in the interactive process (FEHA); (6) failure to prevent discrimination, harassment, or retaliation (FEHA); (7) breach of oral contract not to terminate employment without good cause; (8) breach of implied-in-fact contract not to terminate employment without good cause; (9) negligent hiring, supervision, and retention; (10) wrongful termination in violation of public policy; (11) violation of California Labor Code § 1102.5; (12) intentional infliction of emotional distress; and (13) violation of